Maxwell. However, by this point, individual acts of resistance began to emerge. One man recounted that on 3 October at around 5.15 pm:

I came out of the delicatessen and onto Pirna's market square where, out of frustration and pent-up anger, I shouted: 'Down with Honecker', 'Honecker you rascal, give the little children bananas', and 'We want free elections'. When the Stasi arrived a few minutes later, a small crowd shouted: 'Leave the man alone, he is speaking the truth!'22

A week later, on 7 October, the SED went on with its grandiose celebrations of the 40th anniversary of the founding of the GDR, with guest of honour Mikhail Gorbachev. From the outset, pro-democracy protestors were itching to send a message to the Soviet leader, and at Schoenfeld airport, the screams of 'Gorby! Gorby! Gorby!' could be heard as the Russians arrived. Later that afternoon, at an open-air event, the strain on Honecker was obvious. His gaunt, withered face was pallid like white leather. 'He behaved like he was in a trance,' Gorbachev recounted. 'It was obvious he was not feeling right.'

The recognition that Honecker had to go grew constantly, according to Horst Sindermann, the GDR Parliamentary President. 'The last impetus was given by Gorbachev's visit on the 40th anniversary,' he explained.23 Recounting that trip, he remembered a 'very pleasant' talk between Gorbachev and the Politburo where the Soviet leader 'talked of his problems and of ours. He said we would have it easier with perestroika because we had a strong economy':

Then Honecker replied. He trotted out a speech about the 4-megabit microchip again. I have to say this because he constantly forgot the relative importance of things, the disproportions that arose from the one-sided concentration on microelectronics. In crucial situations, he always produced statistics and said we had higher productivity than the Soviet Union. This